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விவசாயத் திணைக்களம்
Department of Agriculture

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Pests of rice – Rice sheath mite

Sheath mite can be considered as a serious pest in rice crop causing 5% – 90% yield losses. It is microscopic in size. Sheath mites live in the space between leaf sheaths and feed on the adaxial surface of leaf sheath and developing kernels.

Symptoms

- High infestation at booting stage of the crop can be observed as symptoms of chocolate brown color lesions on leaf sheaths.

Effective control methods

- Destroy infected stubbles by plugging just after harvesting or by burning.
- Sun drying of seed paddy before soaking.
- Weed management
- Monitor the crop from early booting stage for chocolate color lesions on leaf sheaths.
- Single application of recommended insecticides if the signs have been observed.
- Follow the field for 2-3 seasons if the problem was not controlled with the above measures.